# INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

## CLOTHS. CLEANING, TREATED (RENTAL SERVICE)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing acitivity at the address shown above.

### 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirement for treated hand cloths, primarily intended for dusting all types of metal and wooden office furniture, to be supplied by commercial sources on a rental basis. The cloths shall be laundered, treated, and maintained in serviceable condition by the supplier.

1.2 Classification

1.2.1 Sizes. Unless otherwise specified, the treated cloths shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 3.2 and 6.2). Sizes in addition to those listed herein may be specified in the invitation for bids at the option of the procuring activity.

Size 1 - 18 by 18 inches.
Size 2 - 18 by 30 inches.

### 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

T-M-001203 - Mops, Dusting (Rental Service).

Federal Standard:

Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.)

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside tye Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.)

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbook and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specifc procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

### 3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Base cloth. Hand dust cloths shall be made from cloth woven of medium soft yarns and conforming to the following physical requirements:



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1.1 Finish. The cloth shall have a soft finish and may be napped or unnapped.

3.1.2 Yarns per inch. The number of yarns per inch shall be not less than 29 in the warp and 34 in the filling for napped cloth and not less than 28 in the warp and 18 in the filling for unnapped cloth when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.1.3 Weight. The weight of the cloth shall be not less than 5.5 ounces per square yard when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.2 Dimensions. The cloths shall be made from one piece of material and, unless otherwise specified (see 1.2.1), shall be of the following sizes:

| | Maximum | Minimum |
|---|---|---|
| Size 1 - | 18 by 18 inches | 13-1/2 by 15 inches |
| Size 2 - | 18 by 30 inches | 15 by 22-1/2 inches |

When specified (see 1.2.1), optional sizes shall meet the size requirements as specified by the procuring activity.

3.3 Edges. All unselvaged edges of the hand cloths shall be hemmed or over-edge stitched.

3.4 Treated cloths. The cloths shall be properly treated with a sufficient quantity of a dust absorbent compound to effectively pick up and retain dust, soil, and lint to such an extent that when the fingers of the hand are swept once over the freshly cleaned area, there shall be no evidence of dirt on the finger tips. The treating compound shall conform to the requirements of 3.4.3 and shall be applied by commercially acceptable methods specified in 3.4.4. In addition to the requirements of 3.1 through 3.3, the following requirements shall apply to the treated cloths:

3.4.1 Breaking strength. The breaking strength of the treated cloths shall be not less than 25 pounds in the warp direction and not less than 40 pounds in the filling direction, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.4.2 Impregnation. The treating compound shall be uniformly dispersed through the cloths and shall be present to the extent of 15.0 percent, minimum, and 25.0 percent, maximum, of the untreated dry weight of the dust cloth when tested in accordance with 4.4.2.

3.4.2.1 The treated cloths shall not be oily or greasy to the touch, or leave oil residues on cleaned surfaces when the surfaces are rubbed with substantial hand pressure, when tested as specified in 4.4.4. The cloths shall not be tacky and shall be readily moved over the surface to be cleaned.

3.4.3 Treating compound. The dust control compound for treating the cloths shall consist of a paraffinic or naphthalenic base petroleum product, germicides, and suitable aromatic when required. The compound shall contain not more than 5.0 percent water, and no animal, or vegetable oil, or any ingredient that will permit or cause it to heat or ignite spontaneously when tested as specified in 4.4.5, and shall have an Underwriters' Laboratories Fire Hazard Rating between 0 and 20. The compound shall contain sufficient bacteriological additives to inhibit the growth and spread of environmental bacteria, such as Staphylococcus aureus, in treated cloths and to reduce contamination on the areas cleaned, when tested in accordance with 4.4.6. Certified laboratory test results shall be submitted as evidence of compliance with these requirements.

3.4.3.1 Laboratory report approval. Certified laboratory test results to be submitted by the contractor, as required herein, may be from his own laboratory, an independent or commercial laboratory acceptable to the government.

3.4.4 Method of treating. The compound shall be applied to the cloths by machine spraying or absorption in the washwheel, in a manner consistent with the best commercial practices.

3.4.5 Dirt pick-up efficiency. Dirt pick-up efficiency of the cloths shall average not less than 20 percent based on the weight of the treated item before soiling, when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.4.6 Action on skin. The treated cloths shall be free from any ingredients that would have an injurious action on normal skin.

3.4.7 Stability. Treated cloths shall not lose their effectiveness or have a tendency to sour or mildew under normal storage conditions.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.8 Odor. Treated cloths shall be free from objectionable odor.

3.5 Color. At the option of the supplier, the cloths may be unbleached or a dyed color. If dyed, the dye used shall in no way interfere with the dust absorbent treatment.

3.6 Condition. Cloths shall be clean in appearance, having no holes, tears, or cuts. Frayed or ragged edges not over 2 inches in length will be acceptable, except that individual cloths containing more than one of these defects shall be rejected.

3.7 Marking. The cloths shall be legibly marked with the supplier's name or trademark using indelible ink.

3.8 Workmanship. The cloths shall be clean and free from defects which seriously affect the appearance and which may impair the serviceability and shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may use his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection of materials and components. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications, unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where indicated hereinafter. For purposes of sampling, an inspection lot for acceptance inspection and tests shall consist of all dust cloths of the same size submitted for inspection and delivery at one time.

4.3.1 Examination of the end item. Sample units shall be examined for the applicable visual defects listed in table I. The unit of product shall be one treated cloth. The sample size shall be in accordance with inspection level I of MIL-STD-105 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 6.5 defects per 100 units.

TABLE I. Visual defects in end item.

| Examine | Defects |
|---|---|
| Material | Not woven.<br>Not a soft finish. |
| Appearance, condition and workmanship | Any hole, cut, or tear.<br>Frayed or ragged edges over 2 inches in length or more than one such defect in individual cloths.<br>Edges other than selvage not hemmed or overedge stitched.<br>Objectionable odor.<br>Dimensions not as specified.<br>Oily or greasy to the touch. |
| Marking | Not identified with supplier's name or trademark by use of permanent ink. |



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4 Testing of the end item. Sample units shall be selected at random from each inspection lot (see 4.3) and subjected to the applicable tests specified herein. The sample unit shall be one dust cloth. The lot shall be unacceptable if the sample average fails to meet average requirements, or if more than one sample unit fails to meet sample unit requirements.

4.4.1 *Physical requirements.* The methods of testing specified in Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 for the applicable characteristics listed in table II shall be followed. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the average of the determinations made on a unit of product for test purposes as specified in the applicable test method.

TABLE II. Test methods.

| Characteristics | Requirement Paragraph | Test Method |
|---|---|---|
| Yarns per inch | 3.1.2 | 5050 |
| Weight | 3.1.3 | 5041 |
| Breaking strength | 3.4.1 | 5100 |

4.4.2 Degree of impregnation. Three sample specimens weighing not less than 30 grams each shall be cut from treated cloths and shall be conditioned and tested in accordance with the procedure specified in 4.4.3 of T-M-001203.

4.4.3 Dirt pick-up efficiency. A specimen consisting of a strip 2 by 3 inches cut from three sample cloths shall be conditioned and tested in accordance with the procedure specified in 4.4.5 of T-M-001203.

4.4.4 Oil residue. A specimen 2-1/2 inches wide and at least 10 inches long shall be cut from each of three sample cloths. The specimen shall be placed flat on a black colored non-absorbent plastic surface 8 inches wide and 15 to 18 inches long. A one (1) kilogram weight shall be placed in middle of specimen 2 inches from one end. Holding the opposite end of the specimen, the specimen shall be pulled parallel along the plastic surface so that the kilogram weight will travel a distance of 12 inches. (Care should be exercised so that the pulling of the specimen does not exert any lifting force on the kilogram weight nor any downward pressure on the specimen other than that of the kilogram weight). Force exerted to pull specimen shall be uniform and such that the kilogram weight will traverse the 12 inch distance in 30 ± 2 seconds. The three specimens shall be so tested and if any one specimen shows disposition of oil on the plastic surface in the 10 inch area the lot shall be rejected.

4.4.5 Spontaneous combustion: Mackey.

4.4.5.1 Apparatus. The apparatus is essentially a vertical cylindrical test chamber surrounded at the sides and bottom by boiling water heated by a hot plate. The apparatus shall be a cylindrical copper container, 8 inches high and 6 inches in diameter which forms a 1-inch water-jacket around the test chamber, which shall be 7 inches deep and 4 inches in diameter.

4.4.5.1.1 The water-jacket shall be provided with an opening to permit the addition of water, and for fitting a reflux condenser (water-cooled) in order to maintain a constant water level.

4.4.5.1.2 The test chamber shall be provided with a cover, consisting of a flange to support it over the chamber opening and two openings fitted with 1/2 inch diameter tubes, one of which extends 6 inches above the cover and the other extends 6 inches down into the chamber to provide for air circulation through the chamber. A third opening at the center of the cover shall be provided for inserting a thermometer (Weston Electrical Instrument Company, Dial Type Maximum Registering Thermometer, 3 inch dial and 12 inch stem, 50°F. to 500°F. with 5°F. divisions and an accuracy of plus or minus 1°F.).

4.4.5.1.3 The sample is contained within the test chamber by a cylinder of copper wire screen 6 inches long and 1-1/2 inches in diameter, which is supported from the bottom of the chamber by stiff copper wire extending from the vent tube.

4.4.5.2 Procedure.

4.4.5.2.1 The test specimen shall consist of a 4 inch by 4 inch square cut from each of three sample cloths. After the test chamber temperature has stabilized as evident by no change in readings at one hour intervals, the three 4 inch by 4 inch specimens shall be introduced into the wire cage so as to surround the thermometer bulb. The cover with the mounted sample is then placed on the opening of the test chamber. The water in the jacket surrounding the chamber shall be maintained at boiling for 72 hours. Any tendency of the sample to heat spontaneously, in 72 hours under the test conditions, shall be indicated by a rise in the temperature of the sample above the ambient temperature of the test chamber.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

**4.4.5.2.2 The test report for this test shall include the following information:**

**(a) The degrees rise in temperature and the position on the temperature scale, i.e., whether over or under 205°F.**

**(b) Whether there is any observable charring or other similar change of appearance of the sample.**

4.4.6 Bacteriostatic activity. The treating compound shall be tested in accordance with the Zone of Inhibition Agar-Plate Method described in Circular 198, United States Department of Agriculture, dated December 1931. For purposes of this test, the Zone of Inhibition shall be not less than 1.0 mm.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging, packing, and marking. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, packaging, packing, and marking shall be in accordance with standard commercial practice.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. This specification is intended to define quality and performance of treated hand cloths received from commercial sources on a rental basis.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Sizes required (see 1.2.1).

(c) Whether a laboratory report is not required (see 3.2.3.1).



GSA DC 69-15388

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.